# META Goes To Mumbai

THEATRE

**FOUR AWARD-WINNING PLAYS WILL BE STAGED AT THE NCPA AS PART OF THE 20-YEAR CELEBRATIONS OF THE MAHINDRA EXCELLENCE IN THEATRE AWARDS**

On the occasion of the 20th anniversary of the Mahindra Excellence in Theatre Awards (META), four of their award-winning plays will be showcased at the National Centre for the Performing Arts (NCPA) in Mumbai. To be held from December 19 to 22, 2024, the plays in Hindi, English, Assamese and Bundeli will be staged at the NCPA's Experimental Theatre.

Jay Shah, vice-president, head-cultural outreach, The Mahindra Group, shares that although all their festivals are designed with a specific city in mind—META being for Delhi—they decided it was time to celebrate their vicennial status by showcasing some of their award-winning plays in another city—Mumbai being the chosen one. "Bruce Guthrie (head of theatre and film, NCPA) was quite eager and proactive in ensuring that this takes place at the NCPA. He's also been a part of the jury at META. Everything just came together beautifully," says Shah.

Although all the award-winning META plays were up for selection, the final four plays—*Andha Yug*, *Agarbatti*, *Raghunath* and *Do You Know This Song?*—were chosen after a lot of deliberation. "Bruce, with his years of experience at the NCPA, was able to ascertain which of the plays would work best with the audience in Mumbai," adds Shah.

For Bidyut Kr Nath, whose play *Raghunath* won six awards at META 2024, including the awards for Best Director and Best Original Script, it is a proud moment. The Assamese play with English subtitles is about a villager named Raghunath who loses his school-going daughter in the floods in Assam. Lack of infrastructure and hope in the face of tragedy are some of the themes the play explores as it beautifully conveys a tale

**Do You Know This Song?** ***by Mallika Taneja (below), invites the audience on a journey of grief and rediscovery as she explores love, loss and the power of memory***



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